

The Vietnam

By

Sayar Ko Ko Lwin

Little Explorers

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On the plane home from Malaysia, Khoon Khoon and Doremi looked at the red and white flag. "A golden star in the middle!" Doremi noticed. Their magical travel book glowed, and a new page appeared titled "Vietnam". "That's where we're going next!" Khoon Khoon cheered.

They landed in Hanoi, the capital. The streets were full of life and sound! Millions of motorbikes zoomed past like a flowing river. "Whoa! How do we cross the road?" Doremi asked, wide-eyed. A friendly local smiled and said, "Just walk slowly and steadily. They will go around you!" Holding hands, they bravely crossed.



They turned a corner and found a very narrow street with train tracks right down the middle!"A train comes through here?" asked Khoon Khoon, surprised. Just then, they heard a whistle. Everyone moved inside their shops, and a train chugged past, incredibly close. "That was amazing!" shouted Doremi.



They explored the Old Quarter, where every street sold something different. One street was full of toy shops, another only sold shoes. "This is Silk Street!" Khoon Khoon said, feeling a soft dress. A shopkeeper said, "Xin chào! Hello! You like it?" They learned their first Vietnamese word: "Cảm ơn! Thank you!"



They took a bus to a famous bay. Thousands of limestone islands covered in green plants rose from the blue water. "It looks like a dragon is lying in the sea!" said Doremi. They boarded a traditional wooden boat called a junk. "Welcome to Hạ Long Bay!" the captain said.



Their boat stopped at an island. They climbed up to a huge cave called Sung Sot (Surprise) Cave. Inside, colourful lights lit up strange rock shapes that looked like animals and giants. "Look, that one looks like a turtle!" Khoon Khoon pointed. "This is the best surprise!" said Doremi.



Kayaking Adventure-They got into a small red kayak and paddled themselves through a quiet lagoon.They waved to other kayakers. "Hello!" they shouted. Their voices echoed off the tall limestone walls. A monkey waved at them from a tree on an island.



They traveled north to the mountains of Sapa. They saw giant steps carved into the mountainsides, all filled with water and green rice plants. "It looks like a green staircase for giants!" said Khoon Khoon. They saw local farmers in colourful traditional clothes working in the fields.



A young girl named Mai from the H'mong ethnic group walked with them. She showed them how her family grows rice and makes beautiful indigo-blue clothes. "Your dress is so pretty," Khoon Khoon said. "Cảm ơn," Mai replied shyly.



They flew to a beautiful ancient town called Hoi An. The streets were lined with old yellow houses and thousands of colourful lanterns. "It feels like a fairy tale!" whispered Khoon Khoon. As the sun set, people placed glowing paper lanterns on the river and made a wish.



They went to a workshop to make their own lanterns. They chose pink silk and carefully put the frame together. "It's tricky!" said Doremi, his tongue sticking out. When they finished, they lit a small candle inside. "We made this!" they said proudly.



Near Ho Chi Minh City, they learned about history. They visited the Củ Chi Tunnels, where people hid during the war. The tunnels were very narrow and dark. They crawled through a widened part. "It's so small down here. They were very brave," Doremi said quietly.



Vietnam's food was fresh and delicious! They sat on small plastic stools on the street and tried phở (beef noodle soup). "Phở is yummy!" said Khoon Khoon, slurping the noodles. They also tried fresh spring rolls. "You dip it in this peanut sauce," a lady showed them.



They tried Vietnamese iced coffee. The strong coffee dripped slowly from a small metal cup into a glass full of sweet milk and ice. "It's very sweet and strong!" said Doremi after a sip. "I like it!" said Khoon Khoon.



In the south, they took a boat trip on the mighty Mekong River. They visited a floating market where people sold fruits and vegetables from their boats. A woman on a boat held up a pineapple. "You want to buy?" she asked. They bought two sweet mangoes instead.



It must be magic!

A Honey Tea Break They visited a bee farm on the river. A man gave them sweet honey tea. He let them hold a big honeycomb. "Bees are important friends," he said. They also tasted delicious coconut candy made right in front of them.



They visited the old imperial city of Huế. They walked through a grand gate into a citadel with palaces and temples. "This is where the emperors lived long ago," their guide said. They pretended to be an emperor and empress for a photo.



They took a ride in acyclo, a three-wheeled bicycle where the passengers sit in the front. They relaxed as the driver pedaled them around the city, giving them a perfect view of all the sights. "This is the best way to see everything!" said Khoon Khoon.



They climbed the steps up the Marble Mountains, a group of five hills made of marble and limestone. They explored caves with Buddhist shrines inside. From the top, they could see the sea and the city of Da Nang. "What a great view!" said Doremi.



They saw a famous bridge held up by two giant stone hands! It looked like a pathway from a giant's garden. "It looks like the hands are holding the bridge up!" said Khoon Khoon. They walked along the bridge, feeling like they were in a magical land.



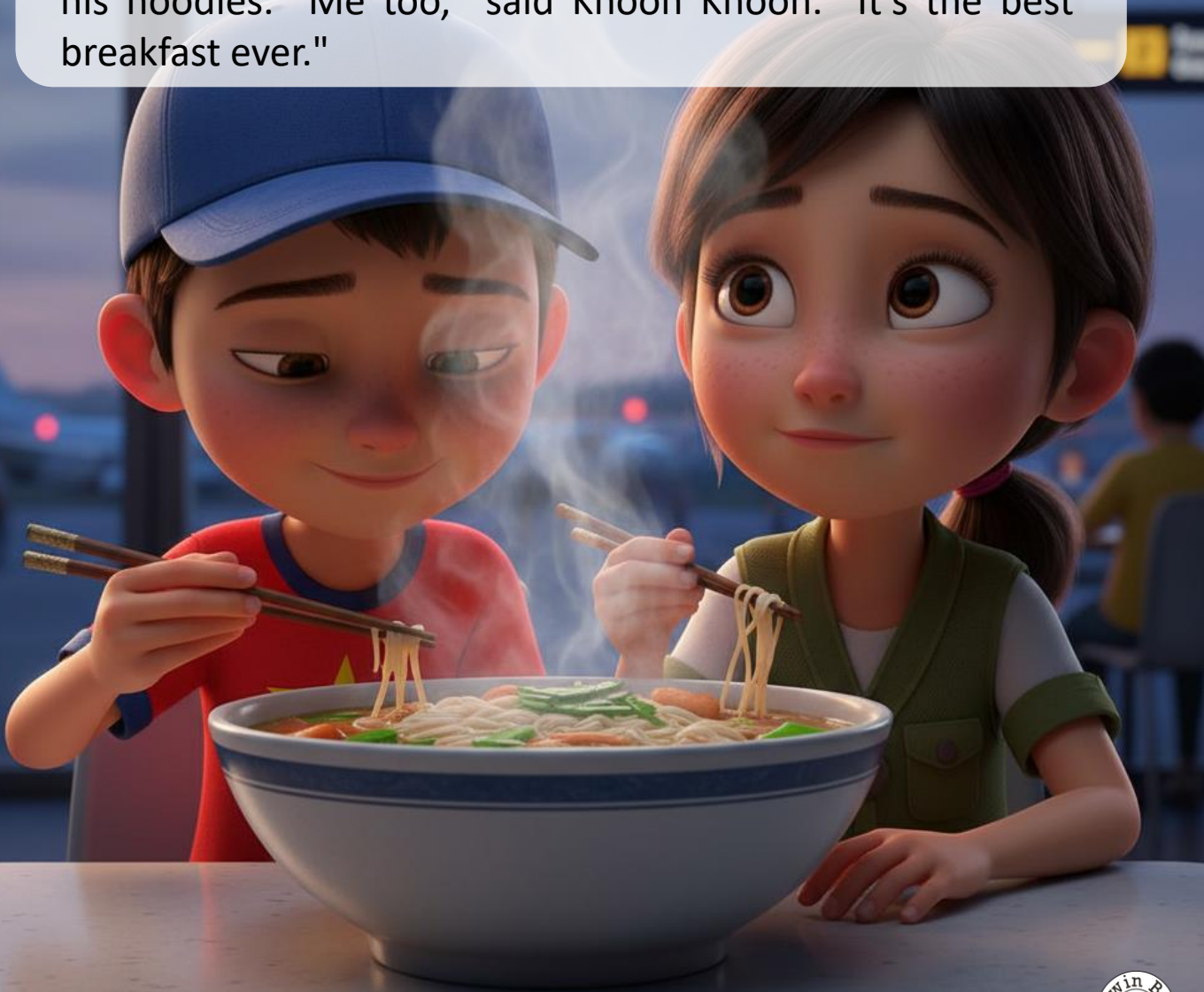
They went to a special theatre to see a water puppet show. Colorful wooden puppets danced and splashed in a pool of water, telling old Vietnamese stories. Musicians played traditional instruments and sang. "How do they do that under the water?" wondered Doremi.



Wherever they went, people were incredibly kind. Children waved and said "Hello!". Market sellers smiled. "Everyone is so friendly here," said Khoon Khoon. They loved saying "Xin chào" (Hello) and "Cảm ơn" (Thank you).



On their last day, they had one more bowl of phở for breakfast. "I'm going to miss this," said Doremi, slurping his noodles. "Me too," said Khoon Khoon. "It's the best breakfast ever."



They packed their souvenirs: a silk lantern, a little rice hat, and a bag of strong coffee for their parents. "We can make Vietnamese coffee at home!" said Doremi.



A Golden Temple As they packed, a small, folded picture fell out of the lantern. It was a beautiful, golden Buddhist temple. "This doesn't look like Vietnam," said Khoon Khoon. "Where do you think this is?" asked Doremi. Their next adventure was already calling...



The End

See you on next Journey...!

This book is created for educational purpose only aim at kids who is above 7 years old by Ko Ko Lwin.

